

Tool / place	What it is	What we used it for
PowerShell	The command window on your laptop	Running Git commands, starting the local app, running tests, and checking project status
Git	Version-history tool on your laptop	Creating named local snapshots of the code: git add, git commit, git status
GitHub	Private cloud home for the code and Git history	Storing the shared cloud copy of Reply Desk and triggering Render deployments
Render	Cloud hosting service	Running the public FastAPI service at spd-reply-desk.onrender.com
Docker	A repeatable packaging environment	Tells Render how to run the Reply Desk backend consistently
Meta for Developers	Meta's developer control panel	Creating the Reply Desk app, adding permissions, setting the webhook, generating tokens, and completing App Review
Instagram API	Meta's official connection to Instagram	Identifying Stephen's professional account and allowing Reply Desk to receive authorised DM/comment events
Webhook/Can use Ngrok	A secure delivery address Meta calls automatically	Lets Meta notify Reply Desk when a DM or comment arrives
Supabase	Cloud database	Stores customer conversation records, inbound messages, drafts, and review actions
FastAPI	Python backend framework	Runs Reply Desk's routes: health check, privacy pages, webhook receiver, draft APIs, and database access
React	The review-screen interface	Displays the conversation trail, suggested draft, Hold, and future review controls
Vite	Local React development server	Lets us open and test the React screen quickly on your laptop
Python tests	Automated checks	Confirm that comment parsing, DM parsing, public pages, and draft rules still work after changes
.env file	Private local settings file	Holds secrets and connection settings locally; it must never go to GitHub
Render environment variables	Private cloud settings	Holds the live Meta token, Meta app secret, database connection, and OpenAI key

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OpenAI API	AI model connection	Configured for future AI draft generation; the current live workflow remains draft-only and rule-based
Windows Game Bar	Windows screen recorder	Recorded the fictional reviewer demo for Meta App Review
Privacy and data-deletion pages	Public Reply Desk pages on Render	Gives Meta and customers a public policy and deletion-contact route

Step What happens

- 1 Customer writes a public Instagram comment or private DM
- 2 Meta sends a signed webhook event to Render
- 3 FastAPI checks the signature and saves the event in Supabase
- 4 Reply Desk creates a draft only
- 5 React shows Stephen the conversation and draft for review
- 6 Stephen decides what to send manually for now